AEP FROM ZERO • PART 2 • SPEAK TO YOUR CUSTOMER (AJO)

EPISODE 24

AJO Journey Not Sending? Triage With Step Events

Why is your Adobe Journey Optimizer (AJO) journey not sending? This AJO troubleshooting tutorial teaches a five-step triage, entry, qualification, wait, action and delivery, with the Journey Step Events dataset as the ground truth. You will learn what the AJO system datasets hold, including AJO Message Feedback and AJO Email Tracking, and how to read Journey Management Reports: Highlights, Journeys, Campaigns, Last 7 full days and UTC. You will also write an email ops report and a five-part

Previously: guardrails that hold

- Last time: two marketing emails a week, everywhere
- Quiet hours in the customer's own time zone
- Suppression list is not an unsubscribe
- Today: why didn't it send?
- Triage, step events, reports, readout

KEY IDEA

Bloom's guardrails held. Today's problem: when a message does not arrive, prove why with evidence instead of guesses.

The question every CRM lead hears

- The question: why didn't it send?
- Theories: the cap, quiet hours, the wait
- Practice: a deliberately broken copy, in dev
- Named with Kavya's initials at the front
- Run once on her own Gold test seat: no welcome

KEY IDEA

When a message does not arrive, everyone has a theory. Divya gives Kavya a deliberately broken copy of the welcome journey to practise on.

The datasets Journey Optimizer writes for you

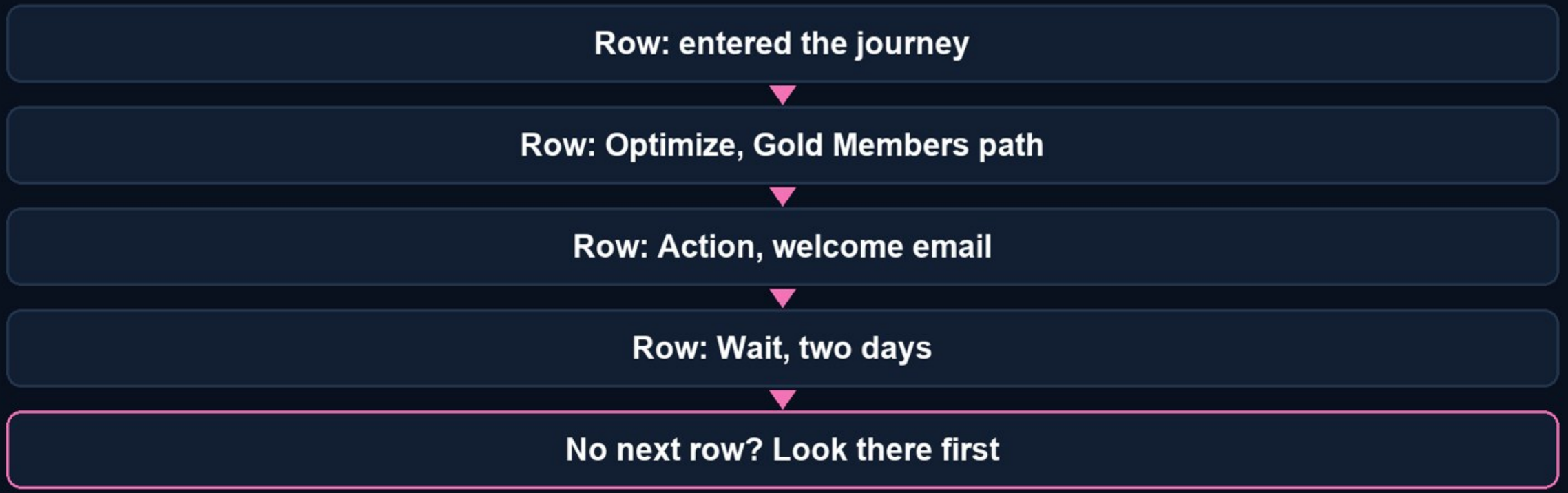
Dataset	What it holds
Journey Step Events	Which profile passed which node
AJO Message Feedback	Delivery events: sends, bounces
AJO Email Tracking	Opens, clicks, unsubscribes
AJO Push Tracking	Push events, such as app launches
AJO ExD Decision Event	Decisioning events, by its name

Names shortened; the notes give each dataset's full name

KEY IDEA

As journeys and campaigns run, AJO writes system datasets into the data lake: step events, message feedback, email and push tracking, decision events.

What are journey step events?



KEY IDEA

Journey Step Events records which profile passed which journey node, with a timestamp. The last row shows exactly where a person stopped.

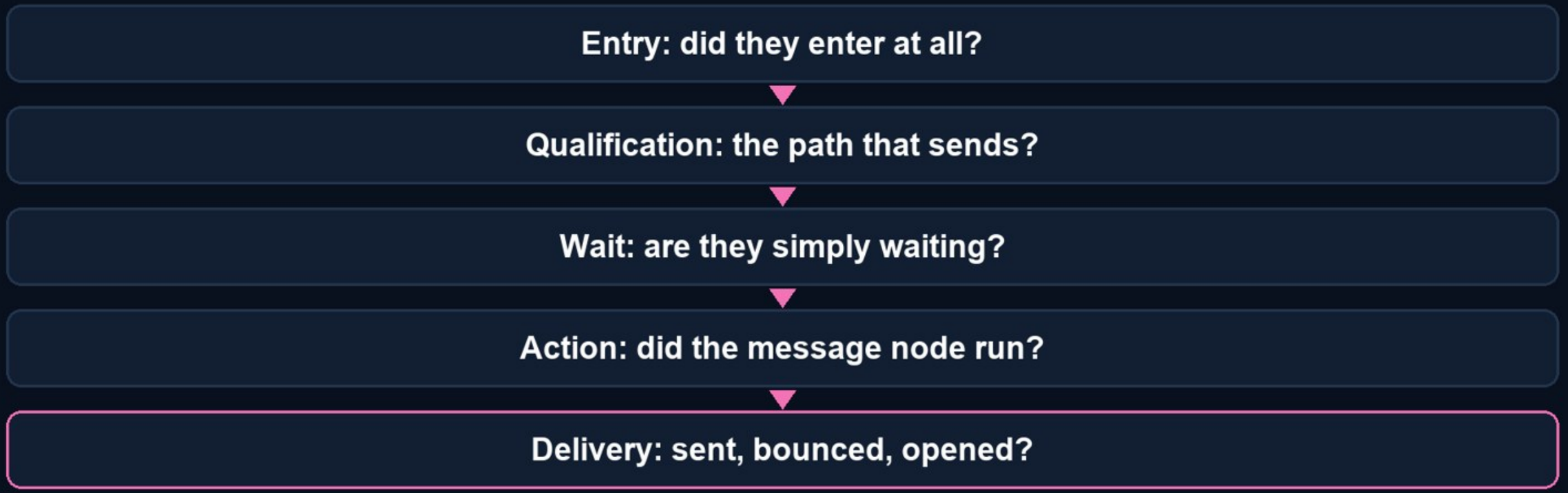
Delivery and engagement: two more datasets

Question	Dataset to read
Did they enter? Which path?	Journey Step Events
Was it sent, or did it bounce?	AJO Message Feedback
Did they open, click, unsubscribe?	AJO Email Tracking
Did they launch the app from a push?	AJO Push Tracking
Which offer was decided?	AJO ExD Decision Event

KEY IDEA

Message Feedback says whether a message was sent or bounced; Email Tracking says what the person did. Feedback arrives in batches, up to two hours late.

Why didn't my journey send? Five steps



KEY IDEA

Triage in order: entry, qualification, wait, action, delivery. Most people start at the end and blame the email or the cap.

Entry and qualification, with Bloom's journeys

- No entry row: the journey never received them
- Check the audience, the event, the journey is live
- Re-entrance settings can keep a person out
- Entered but no message? Read the path taken
- Conditions see only the journey's data source

KEY IDEA

No entry row: check the entry and re-entrance. An entry row but no message: check which path the person took at the split.

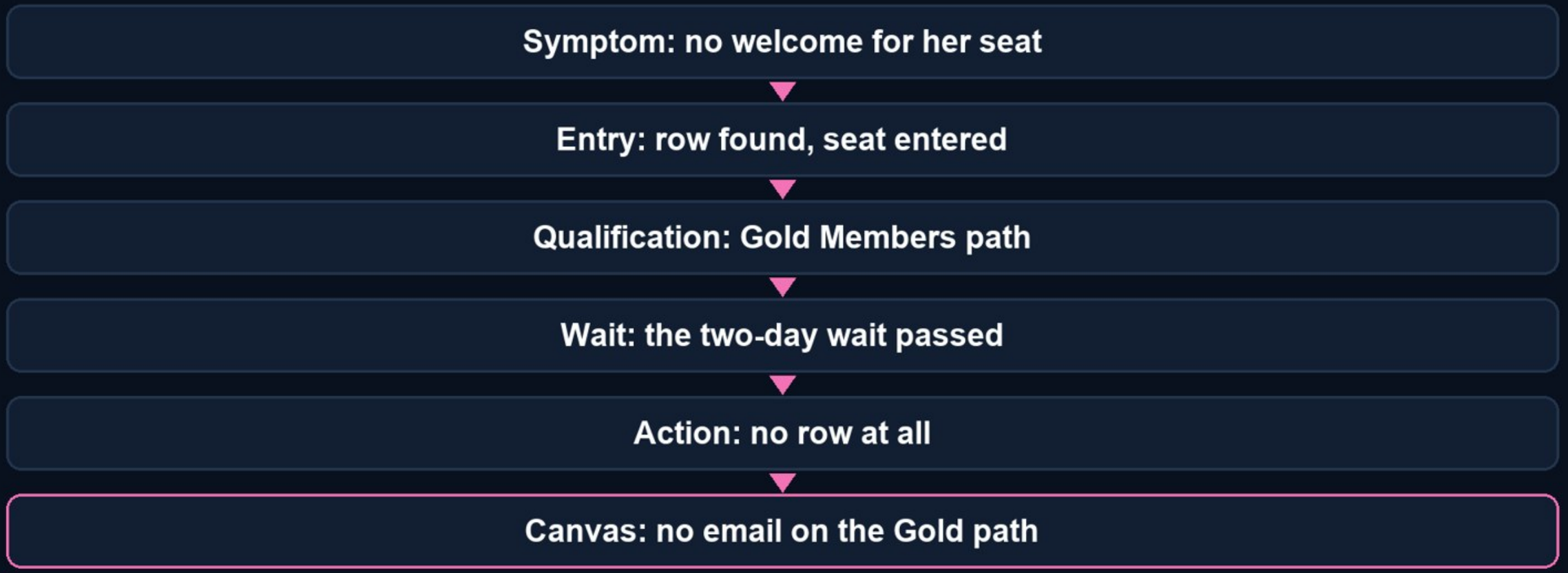
Wait, action, delivery: when silence is correct

- Trail ends at a wait: not lost, just waiting
- Exited on purchase: the design working
- No action row: no message was attempted
- Action row: now check delivery and guardrails
- Quiet hours can queue or discard a message

KEY IDEA

A person in a wait, or one who exited on purchase, gets no message yet, and that can be the design working. Guardrails act only at the send.

Kavya triages the broken copy



KEY IDEA

Step events showed entry, the Gold Members path and the wait, then nothing. No action row meant no message was ever attempted, so it was never the cap.

The fix and the five-part incident note

Part	Kavya's note
Symptom	Gold seat entered, no welcome arrived
Evidence trail	Entry, Gold path, wait, no action row
Root cause	Email action missing on the Gold path
Fix	Action restored; rerun shows a send
Prevention	A second person checks every path

KEY IDEA

An incident note has five parts: symptom, evidence trail, root cause, fix, prevention. Without evidence and prevention, a fix is a lucky guess.

Journey Management, Reports

- Journey Management, then Reports
- Default period: Last 7 full days, in UTC
- Highlights: Journey Enters, Journey Failures
- Also CTR, CTOR, Spam Complaints, Unsubscribes
- Journeys, with Journey Exclusions, then Campaigns
- Powered by Customer Journey Analytics

KEY IDEA

Reports shows every journey and campaign at once: Highlights, Journeys with Journey Exclusions, and Campaigns, for the Last 7 full days, in UTC.

What goes in a weekly email ops report?

Line	What to write
Sends	How many messages went out
Delivery rate	Delivered divided by sent
Opens	How many emails were opened
Two flags	Two numbers to act on, one line each

Ops figures in this episode are illustrative

KEY IDEA

Four lines: sends, delivery rate, opens, and two numbers to flag with one sentence each, on one stated period, after late data has landed.

Kavya's first readout for Anjali

- Period: the relaunch fortnight, in UTC
- Sends, delivery rate, opens
- Flag, say: spam complaints on Bloom Win-Back
- Flag, say: Journey Failures on Cart Rescue v1
- Anjali: did any of it work?

KEY IDEA

Kavya widened the period to the fortnight, waited for late feedback, and wrote four lines. Anjali's reply opens Act Three: did any of it work?

Ops hygiene in a shared organisation

Habit	Bloom's rule
Naming	Purpose and version; initials on copies
Versioning	Live is read-only, so change by version
Archiving	Close to new entrances; record why
Change discipline	One owner, a note, a second pair of eyes

KEY IDEA

The next person to open a journey should know what it is without asking: clear names, new versions, deliberate archiving and one owner.

Interview corner

- I read the step events in order
- Entry, qualification, wait, action, delivery
- Asked: tell me about a journey that failed
- Answer with the five-part incident note

KEY IDEA

When a journey does not send, I read the step events in order: entry, qualification, wait, action, delivery.

Recap, your question, and three numbers

- Triage: entry, qualification, wait, action, delivery
- Step events are the ground truth
- Feedback lags up to 2 hours; reports run in UTC
- Readout: sends, delivery rate, opens, two flags
- Next: Act Three, CJA and the person ID

KEY IDEA

Triage in order with step events, wait for late feedback, report four lines. Next: Act Three, Customer Journey Analytics and the person ID.